

this to address the disruptions that millennials were bringing to their model. From a business perspective, it was a more cost-effective way to support this demographic. However, this approach *addressed* rather than *engaged* the demographic. Further research is making it clear that millennials are concerned enough to talk about their financial futures, sometimes more so than their baby boomer parents. A study from Transamerica reports the following:

Three out of four (76 percent) Millennial workers are discussing saving, investing, and planning for retirement with family and friends. Surprisingly, Millennials (18 percent) are twice as likely to “frequently” discuss the topic compared to Baby Boomers (9 percent).⁶

This from a generation that watched their parents significantly impacted by the Great Recession, either through downsizings or losses in investment portfolios. Many of them consider the stock markets akin to gambling casinos. However, they also recognize the value of saving, investing, and planning for the future. Wealth management firms that believe online investing sites will placate millennials until they get older and wealthier (and reach the minimum for a financial advisor relationship) are missing the point of disruption. As many of the wealth management firms have ignored them, millennials may be turning their backs on these firms as well, and not surprisingly, they’re looking for investment vehicles and firms they can feel comfortable with. In fact, a digital native generation likely has little problem accepting the value of a digital native asset. A recent article in *Huffington Post* had this to say: